

Morgan Rivera

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Summary

Engineering leader transitioning from senior IC to people management. Eight years building product engineering teams, recently serving as Tech Lead for a 9-person squad. Combines hands-on system design background with hiring, coaching, and delivery planning. Seeking Engineering Manager or Team Lead roles.

Skills

Leadership: 1:1 coaching, performance feedback, hiring loops, sprint planning, stakeholder communication

Technical: Python, TypeScript, React, PostgreSQL, AWS, system design (still code reviews weekly)

Process: OKRs, roadmap prioritization, incident retros, cross-functional alignment with PM/Design

Work Experience

Tech Lead / Senior Software Engineer - Atlas HR Platform

Denver, CO · Jan 2021 - Present

- Led squad of 9 engineers (3 mid, 4 junior, 2 contractors) delivering payroll integrations product line.
- Ran hiring for 6 full-time engineers; built structured interview rubrics and debrief templates adopted org-wide.
- Facilitated quarterly planning with PM; translated roadmap into sprint goals and capacity-adjusted commitments.
- Drove migration to trunk-based development; reduced release rollback rate from 8% to under 2%.
- Still contributed ~20% IC work: critical path API changes in Python/FastAPI and review of frontend PRs.
- Coached two mid-level engineers into tech-lead responsibilities; one promoted to Senior in 2024.
- Partnered with Customer Success on escalations; instituted weekly bug triage that cut open Sev-2 count by 40%.

Senior Software Engineer - Loop Commerce

Remote · Mar 2018 - Dec 2020

- Backend lead for subscription billing service (Stripe, webhooks, dunning emails).
- Mentored 3 junior developers; established team coding standards and PR checklist.
- Represented engineering in executive readouts for renewal and churn metrics.

Software Engineer - Pinewood Digital

Chicago, IL · Jun 2016 - Feb 2018

- Full-stack features for e-commerce clients (React, Node.js, MongoDB).
 - Onboarded new hires and documented local dev setup reducing first-PR time from 2 weeks to 4 days.
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Management & Leadership Highlights

- **Team health:** Introduced biweekly retros and anonymous pulse surveys; eNPS for squad improved from +12 to +38 over one year.
 - **Delivery:** Improved predictable velocity by splitting epics into vertical slices and defining explicit "done" criteria with QA.
 - **Cross-team:** Led working group with Data Engineering on shared customer identity model; unblocked 3 dependent teams.
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Education

B.A. Information Systems - University of Illinois Chicago · 2016

Training: Manager Tools "Basics" workshop (2023), Reforge Engineering Leadership cohort (2024)